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By the spiritual sight of

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Founder of Dawat-e-Islami Hazrat Allamah Mawlana

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TABLE OF CONTENTS

01

Commentary of the Noble Quran
Creation's Love for the Pious

03

Dar Al-Ifta Ahl Al-Sunnah

07

Hadith and its Explanation
Allah is the Giver, and he ﷺ
is the Distributor

09

Laws of Trade

12

Questions & Answers
from Madani Muzakarah

15

Rulings for Islamic Sisters

17

Blessed Characteristics of
My Beloved Prophet ﷺ
The Blessed Sons
and Blessed Daughters
of the Beloved Prophet ﷺ

18

Bright Stars
The Leader of the Just, Sayyidunā
‘Umar al-Fārūq al-A‘ẓam رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

20

The Holy Prophet's ﷺ
Compassion for Children

21

Some Unique Habits of Imam
Aḥmad Razā Khān رَحْمَةُ اللَّهِ عَلَيْهِ

22

Islam and Women
The Blessed Domestic Life
of the Holy Prophet ﷺ

24

History of Islam
The Field of Karbala

26

Our Pious Predecessors
The Preaching of Islam by
Dātā Ganj Bakhsh رَحْمَةُ اللَّهِ عَلَيْهِ

28

Children! Stay Away From
These Habits

29

The Way to Lead a
Peaceful Life



CREATION'S LOVE FOR THE PIOUS

Mufti Abu Salih Muhammad
Qasim Attari



Allah Almighty says:

إِنَّ الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا وَعَمِلُوا الصَّالِحَاتِ سَيَجْعَلُ لَهُمُ الرَّحْمَنُ وُدًّا ۝

Those who believe and perform righteous deeds, soon the Infinitely Gracious shall create love for them.¹

Commentary:

In the explanation of this blessed verse, many exegetes have mentioned a blessed hadith recorded in Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī and Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim. The beloved Prophet صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ stated:

When Allah Almighty loves a servant, He says to Sayyidunā Jibrīl عَلَيْهِ السَّلَام, "Indeed, Allah loves so-and-so person, therefore you should also love him." So, Sayyidunā Jibrīl عَلَيْهِ السَّلَام loves him. Then Sayyidunā Jibrīl عَلَيْهِ السَّلَام announces to the dwellers of the heavens, "Indeed, Allah loves so-and-so person, therefore you should also love him." Thus, the dwellers of the heavens also begin to love him. Then, acceptance for him is placed among the people of the earth.²

In Jāmi' Tirmidhī, it is mentioned that the final Prophet صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ recited the above-mentioned verse while explaining this hadith.³

Sayyidunā 'Abdullāh b. 'Abbās رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا said: "Allah Almighty places the love of a good man into the hearts of the people." Regarding the word وُدًّا, it has been further explained that it refers to a good livelihood in this world, a good mention on the tongues of the people, and love in the hearts of the Muslims.

Imam Mujāhid رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ said: "Allah Almighty loves

that servant Himself and makes them beloved to His servants too."⁴

Sayyidunā Harim b. Ḥayyān رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ states: "When a servant turns towards Allah Almighty with his heart, Allah Almighty turns the hearts of the believers towards him, until He grants him their love and affection."⁵

Shaykh Ismā'īl Ḥaqqī رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ has explained the fruits of faith and pious deeds using a beautiful example. He says: "This verse points to the fact that when the seed of faith is sown in the soil of the heart and is nurtured with the water of pious deeds, it continues to grow. Eventually, its fruit appears. This fruit is the love of Allah Almighty, the love of the noble Prophets عَلَيْهِمُ السَّلَام وَالسَّلَام, the angels, and all the believers."⁶

From the words of the Quran and Hadith, we learn that the widespread acceptance of pious believers and perfect Saints is a proof of Divine love. It is a special gift from Allah Almighty. We see clear proof of this in the blessed personalities of Shaykh 'Abd al-Qādir al-Jīlānī, Khwājah Gharīb Nawāz, Bābā Farīd Ganj Shakar, Dātā Ganj Bakhsh 'Alī Hujwayrī, Imam Mujaddid Alf Thānī, the Imam of Ahl al-Sunnah Imam Aḥmad Razā Khan, and Pir Mehr 'Alī Shāh رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ, as well as thousands of other pious elders.

According to the hadith, the hearts of the people naturally incline towards the pious and the Saints. These righteous people do not make efforts to become famous or popular. As Imam Fakhr al-Dīn al-Rāzī رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ writes: "One view is that Allah Almighty creates love in the hearts of the people for

the pious, even though these pious people do not seek love from others, nor do they try to become popular. Rather, this is an act of Allah Almighty (creating love in people's hearts)."⁷

When we look at the meanings of this blessed verse and the pious deeds and good character of the Saints, our faith in the truth of the holy Quran is refreshed. When we look at the lives of different Saints, we see the branches of "pious deeds" swaying on the tree of faith. Their lives are a reflection of following the Book (Quran) and the Sunnah. They prefer the Hereafter over this world. In their daily routines, we see them staying awake at night for worship, having a soft heart, standing in prayer at night, bowing and prostrating with love and fear, remembering Allah Almighty, reciting the noble Quran, thinking deeply, and seeking forgiveness.

In their hearts, we find the qualities of scrutinising their own actions, sincerity, patience, gratitude, trust in Allah Almighty, perfect belief in the Oneness of Allah (*Tawhīd*), submission and pleasure, contentment, and abstinence from the world. We also see their worry for the Hereafter, satisfaction and submission to Allah's will, wishing well for others, and respect for Muslims. In their words and actions, we find soft speech, a search for truth, thinking well of Muslims, forgiving others, and overlooking faults. They show good character to those who oppose them and fulfil the rights of people. They display affection and mercy to the creation. Their way of life is humble. Despite all these qualities, they remain afraid of the **Hidden plan** of Allah Almighty and a bad end.

These are the people whose qualities as believers, pious, patient, grateful, fearful, obedient, loving and sincere individuals, and those who have certainty, are clearly visible. As a reward, Allah Almighty places their love and devotion in the hearts of the people. Look at the Saints; they are lying in their resting places today, yet people are drawn to them. We have not seen the pious people of the past, but look at the present-day scholars, the pious, and the spiritual guides who follow the path of *taqwā* (piety). People love them so much and speak so well of them.

A great example of this is the founder of Dawat-e-Islami, Amīr Ahl al-Sunnah, Mawlānā

Muhammad Ilyas Attar Qadiri دَامَتْ بَرَكَاتُهُمُ الْعَالِيَّةُ. You can see his global popularity and the love people have for him. All of this is due to the blessings of those pious deeds that are done only for the sake of Allah Almighty with sincerity.

Usually, the difference between showing off and sincerity is hidden from people, but Allah Almighty knows everything. He grants rewards according to the reality of one's actions. Imam Ḥasan al-Baṣrī رَحْمَةُ اللَّهِ عَلَيْهِ mentions:

A man once said, "By Allah! I will worship Allah Almighty so much that I become famous among the people." So, whenever it was time for prayer, he was seen standing in prayer. He was the first to enter the masjid and the last to leave. This continued for seven months. During this time, whenever he passed by people, they would say, "Look at this person who shows off."

One day, he thought to himself, "I am being mentioned with bad words. Now, I will do every action only for the sake of Allah." He simply changed his intention and continued his actions as before. After this, when he passed by people, they began to say, "May Allah have mercy on so-and-so."

Then Imam Ḥasan al-Baṣrī رَحْمَةُ اللَّهِ عَلَيْهِ recited this verse:

إِنَّ الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا وَعَمِلُوا الصَّالِحَاتِ سَيَجْعَلُ لَهُمُ الرَّحْمَنُ وُدًّا ﴿٦١﴾

Those who believe and perform righteous deeds, soon the Infinitely Gracious shall create love for them.⁸

May Allah Almighty grant us the ability to perform pious deeds with sincerity. آمِينَ

¹ Al-Quran, Surah Maryam, verse 96; translation from Kanz al-'Irfān

² Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī, vol. 2, p. 382, hadith: 3209; Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim, p. 1086, hadith: 6705

³ Sunan al-Tirmidhi, vol. 5, p. 109, hadith: 3172

⁴ Tafsīr al-Ṭabarī, vol. 8, p. 385, under verse 96

⁵ Tafsīr al-Khāzin, vol. 3, p. 248, under verse 96

⁶ Rūḥ al-Bayān, vol. 5, p. 359, under verse 96

⁷ Al-Tafsīr al-Kabīr, vol. 7, p. 567, Surah Maryam, under verse 96

⁸ Al-Quran, Surah Maryam, verse 96; translation from Kanz al-'Irfān

DAR AL-IFTA

AHL AL-SUNNAH

What is the ruling on saying, "Not everything happens by the will of Allah"?

The Ruling on a Masjid Imam Appointing a Deputy for Hajj Holidays and Receiving Salary

Question: What do the scholars of Islam say regarding the following matter: If a muezzin and the imam of a masjid take extra holidays beyond the standard leaves due to the blessing of performing Hajj and Umrah, will the salary for those extra days be deducted or not? Furthermore, if during this time he appoints a person, who fulfils the criteria of the Shariah, as his deputy and that deputy performs the duties of the imam on his behalf, what is the ruling regarding the salary for those days?

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

الْجَوَابُ بِعَوْنِ الْمَلِكِ الْوَهَّابِ اللَّهُمَّ هِدَايَةَ الْحَقِّ وَالصَّوَابِ

The imam and muezzin are only allowed as many holidays as are customary and prevalent in that place. Any holidays beyond that—whether without an excuse or due to an excuse such as Hajj and Umrah—must result in a deduction of salary. However, if he appoints a person capable of leading the prayer as his deputy for those days, this deputy system is correct. In this case, the original imam is the one entitled to the salary for those days. Then, the original imam will give the deputy the wages that were agreed upon between them.

وَاللَّهُ أَكْبَرُ عَزَّوَجَلَّ وَرَسُولُهُ أَكْبَرُ

صَلَّى اللَّهُ تَعَالَى عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ

Answered by:

The humble servant, Muhammad Fuzail Raza al-Attari

Question: What do the scholars of Islam say regarding the following matter: Zayd said to his friend Bakr, "You cannot get this thing." Bakr replied, "If Allah wills, it will be obtained." Zayd said, "Not every work happens by the will of Allah; in some works, humans also have a choice." The question is, how is this reply of Zayd?

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

الْجَوَابُ بِعَوْنِ الْمَلِكِ الْوَهَّابِ اللَّهُمَّ هِدَايَةَ الْحَقِّ وَالصَّوَابِ

In the situation mentioned, the ruling of disbelief (*kufir*) on Zayd is completely clear. It is obligatory for him to repent and renew his faith.

If he is married, he must also renew his marriage contract. This is because the sentence he spoke in response to Bakr's words (i.e., "If Allah wills, it will be obtained") clearly means that some things can happen without the will of Allah Almighty. Holding such a belief is clear disbelief and a denial of Islamic beliefs.

This is because the correct belief mentioned in the Quran and Hadith is that everything—big or small—happens only by the will of Allah Almighty. Nothing can happen without His will. In fact, if He does not will it, a person cannot even wish for anything. As Allah Almighty states:

وَمَا تَشَاءُونَ إِلَّا أَنْ يَشَاءَ اللَّهُ رَبُّ الْعَالَمِينَ ﴿٢١٠﴾

And you cannot want anything unless Allah, Lord of all the worlds, wills it.¹

وَاللَّهُ أَكْبَرُ عَزَّوَجَلَّ وَرَسُولُهُ أَكْبَرُ صَلَّى اللَّهُ تَعَالَى عَلَيْهِ

وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ

Answered by: Muhammad Sajid al-Attari

Verified by: The humble servant, Muhammad Fuzail Raza al-Attari

The Ruling on a Bribe Given as a Gift

Question: What do the scholars of Islam say regarding the following matter: Zayd gave a gift to Bakr as a bribe, but now Zayd has repented for this sin. Is it necessary to take back the gift he gave, or can he forgive it? What will be the ruling if the gift still exists or if it has been lost?

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ
الْجَوَابُ بِعَوْنِ الْمَلِكِ الْوَهَّابِ اللَّهُمَّ هِدَايَةَ الْحَقِّ وَالصَّوَابِ

In Shariah, the person receiving something as a bribe does not become its owner. Instead, the owner remains the person to whom the item originally belonged. Therefore, in the situation mentioned, it is obligatory for Bakr—who took the bribe—to return Zayd's item to him. Zayd also has the right to demand his item back.

However, if Zayd has now repented and wants to forgive the item for the person who took it, there are two situations:

1. If Bakr has already destroyed or used up the item, then Zayd can forgive it. Forgiving it would mean that the compensation (payment) that became due on Bakr for destroying the item is now waived and forgiven.
2. If the item still exists with Bakr, then Bakr will not become the owner even if Zayd forgives it. Instead, the item will still belong to Zayd. This is because an actual physical item itself is not "forgiven"; rather, a responsibility due from someone is pardoned. Therefore, if Zayd now wants to give that item into Bakr's ownership, he must gift (*hibah*) it anew. As soon as Bakr accepts it, the item will then come into Bakr's ownership.

Warning: It should be clear that taking or giving a bribe with the intention of using this method of gifting later will not make the bribe permissible. Instead, the bribe will remain forbidden (*haram*). This method will not provide an escape from the sin; in fact, in some cases, this gift itself will be called a bribe.

وَاللَّهُ أَعْلَمُ عَزَّ وَجَلَّ وَرَسُولُهُ أَعْلَمُ صَلَّى اللَّهُ تَعَالَى عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ

Answered by: Muhammad Sajid al-Attari

Verified by: The humble servant, Muhammad Fuzail Raza al-Attari

An Important Matter Regarding Giving Children for Adoption

Question: What do the scholars of Islam say regarding the following matter: Zayd gave his two sons to his sister-in-law for adoption with the consent of his wife. The children were only one day old at that time. Now their ages are 8 and 10 years. Zayd now wants to take his children back from them. Does he have the right to take them back or not? No relationship of suckling (*radā'ah*) was established with the children.

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ
الْجَوَابُ بِعَوْنِ الْمَلِكِ الْوَهَّابِ اللَّهُمَّ هِدَايَةَ الْحَقِّ وَالصَّوَابِ

In our society, when a person gives his son to a relative for adoption, it is understood that he will not take him back. It is expected that the child will stay with the person who adopted him, and that person will arrange for his complete education and upbringing. So, in the context of giving a child for adoption, there is a customary promise of not taking him back. According to the rule, "What is known by custom is equivalent to what is stated explicitly." Therefore, in the mentioned situation, Zayd should keep his promise and should not take the children back, provided there is no harm to the children's education and upbringing. However, if the education and upbringing are not being carried out correctly, the children should be taken back, and this will not be called a breach of promise, even though his intention at the time of giving was not to take them back.

In any case, it should be kept in mind that giving one's child for adoption to someone is permissible, but adoption is not a contract that cuts the child's connection with his real father. The person adopting does not become the owner, nor does the child become his real son. It cannot be said that the real father cannot take him back. Rather, it only means that the father has given his right of upbringing to someone else, and this right can be taken back after giving it.

The scholars of Islamic law state a similar rule: If a woman who has the right of upbringing gives up her right and gives it to another woman, and then later wants the children back (and is capable of raising them), she can take them back. Furthermore, if there is a fear of breaking laws of Shariah by leaving the child with the person raising them, the child must be taken back.

When a similar question was asked to Imam Ahl al-Sunnah, Imam Ahmad Razā Khān رَحْمَةُ اللهِ عَلَيْهِ regarding an adopted girl who had nearly reached maturity (or had become an adult) and the person raising her was a stranger (not a *maḥram*), there was a concern regarding the lack of veiling and the risk of fitnah. Since the father wanted her back, Imam Ahl al-Sunnah رَحْمَةُ اللهِ عَلَيْهِ stated with emphasis:

Now that she has become an adult or has nearly reached maturity, she must stay with her father until she gets married. In fact, after the age of nine, a girl is taken even from her real mother to stay with her father. It is certainly not allowed for her to stay with a stranger. Calling someone a daughter and raising them does not make them a real daughter. Whatever the person spent on the child, he spent it considering the child his own and not as a loan; therefore, he is not entitled to get that money back either.²

وَاللَّهُ أَكْلَمُ عَزَّ وَجَلَّ وَرَسُولُهُ أَكْلَمُ صَلَّى اللَّهُ تَعَالَى عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ

Answered by:

Muhammad Hashim Khan al-Attari al-Madani

What is the Ruling on Using Masjid Funds for Illuminations?

Question: What do the scholars of Islam say regarding the following matter: Can we buy lights for illumination (decorative lighting) in the masjid using the masjid's donation money? Buying is easier because, nowadays, lights can be bought at a much lower price compared to renting them. This would make it easy to arrange illuminations on various occasions, such as the major nights of Shab-e-Barā'at and Ramadan al-Mubārak.

Questioner: Muhammad Hasan Attari (Light House,

Bab-ul-Madinah Karachi)

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ
الْجَوَابُ يُعَوِّنُ الْمَلِكِ الْوَهَّابِ اللَّهُمَّ هِدَايَةَ الْحَقِّ وَالصَّوَابِ

Masjid donations are given for the standard expenses of the masjid. For example: construction, paying utility bills, salaries of the imam, muezzin, and staff, and expenses for cleaning.

The ruling regarding using this donation for illuminating the masjid is that if the donors have given explicit or implicit permission, it can be done; otherwise, it is not allowed.

"Explicit" permission means that while collecting donations for the masjid, it was clearly stated: "We will also use your donation for lighting the masjid on the occasion of the Blessed Mawlid and other auspicious nights," and the donor gave permission.

"Implicit" permission means the donors know that this masjid is illuminated on the occasion of the Blessed Mawlid and other significant nights (including the nights of Ramadan), and they know the masjid donation is used for it.

If there is explicit or implicit permission, it is allowed to either buy the lights or rent them. That option should be chosen which is more beneficial for the masjid. However, the best way is to collect a separate donation for purchasing lights for the masjid for Rabī al-Awwal and other occasions, or to ask a generous person to buy these lights and donate them to the masjid.

وَاللَّهُ أَكْلَمُ عَزَّ وَجَلَّ وَرَسُولُهُ أَكْلَمُ صَلَّى اللَّهُ تَعَالَى عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ

Answered by: Abu Huzaifah Muhammad Shafiq al-Attari al-Madani

Verified by: Abu al-Salih Muhammad Qasim al-Qadri

The Ruling on Reciting Prophetic odes with Daff and Dhikr

Question: What do the scholars of Islam say regarding the following matter: How is it to recite and listen to Prophetic odes with a *Daff* (frame drum)?

Also, is it permissible to recite and listen to Prophetic odes that have the *Dhikr* of Allah in the background?

Requester: Zayn al-Abidin (Gulistan Colony, Rawalpindi)

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ
الْجَوَابُ بِعَوْنِ الْمَلِكِ الْوَهَّابِ اَللّهُمَّ هِدَايَةَ الْحَقِّ وَالصَّوَابِ

Reciting the praise of the holy Prophet ﷺ is undoubtedly a source of reward and blessings. It causes the mercy of Allah Almighty to descend and is a way to gain the pleasure of the beloved Prophet ﷺ and increase in his love. However, like all other matters, it is necessary to follow the Shariah in this as well.

Therefore, if a *daff* has cymbals, playing it is completely forbidden. Reciting a Prophetic ode with such a *daff* is even more forbidden and is a severe sin. If the *daff* does not have cymbals, playing it is allowed with three conditions. If even one condition is missing, it is not allowed:

1. It should not be played in the style of musical entertainment (i.e., it should not follow the principles of music).
2. The people playing it should not be men, because playing the *daff* is absolutely disliked (*makrūh*) for them.
3. The women playing it should not be from noble families, and if young girls play it, it must be in a context free from temptation (*fitnah*).

The playing of the *daff* mentioned in the noble *Aḥādīth* was of this nature.

The methods used nowadays do not meet all the conditions for playing the *daff*. Therefore, playing such a *daff* and reciting Prophetic odes with it is not permissible.

As for reciting *dhikr* along with the Prophetic ode: the common way *dhikr* is recited nowadays—where a sound like a drum is produced and the *dhikr* is used as a "background" to make the Prophetic ode sound more attractive—has been forbidden by senior scholars. Our fatwa is also the same. In some places, it has been seen that those performing *dhikr* do not even pronounce the

name of Allah Almighty properly, or they change the words to create a loud beat. This is very disrespectful and is not allowed. Listening to such *dhikr* is also forbidden.

وَاللَّهُ أَعْلَمُ عَزَّ وَجَلَّ وَرَسُولُهُ أَعْلَمُ صَلَّى اللَّهُ تَعَالَى عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ

Answered by: The humble servant, Muhammad Naveed Chishti

Verified by: Abu al-Salih Muhammad Qasim al-Qadri

¹ Al-Quran, Al- Takwīr, verse 29; translation from Kanz al-Irfān

² Al-Fatāwā al-Riḍāwīyyah, vol. 13, p. 413

ALLAH IS THE GIVER, AND HE ﷺ IS THE DISTRIBUTOR

Mufti Hassan Raza Attari Madani

The holy Prophet ﷺ stated: **إِنَّمَا أَنَا قَاسِمٌ وَاللَّهُ** **يُعْطِي**, which means, “I am only the distributor, and it is Allah Who is giving.”¹

In this blessed hadith, it is not clearly stated what the beloved Prophet ﷺ distributes. In such a case, according to the principles, the meaning will be that the holy Prophet ﷺ distributes every single blessing. No one can receive anything without his mediation.

The great jurist of India, Mufti Muhammad Sharif al-Ḥaqq al-Amjadī رحمه الله عليه says:

No one in the creation can receive anything without the mediation of the beloved Prophet ﷺ. There is an authentic hadith in Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī and other collections that states: **إِنَّمَا أَنَا قَاسِمٌ وَاللَّهُ يُعْطِي**. The associated words for **قَاسِمٌ** and **يُعْطِي** are omitted, which gives the benefit of generality. This means that whatever Allah gives to the creation—whether it is a physical or spiritual blessing, or whether it is seen or hidden—He gives it all through the hands of the

merciful Prophet ﷺ. For this reason, Imam Aḥmad al-Khaṭīb al-Qaṣṭallānī رحمه الله عليه, the commentator of Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī, stated in the book *al-Mawāḥib al-Ladunniyyah*, and Imam Muhammad b. ‘Abd al-Bāqī al-Zurqānī رحمه الله عليه also maintained this:

هُوَ صَلَّى اللَّهُ تَعَالَى عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ خِزَانَةُ الْبَرِّ وَمَوْضِعُ تَفْوِذِ الْأَمْرِ فَلَا يُنْقَلُ خَيْرٌ إِلَّا عَنْهُ وَلَا يَنْفَعُ أَمْرٌ إِلَّا مِنْهُ صَلَّى اللَّهُ تَعَالَى عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ

This means that the holy Prophet ﷺ is the treasury of secrets and the locus of the enforcement of commands. Therefore, every good thing is passed on only from the holy Prophet ﷺ, and every command is fulfilled only through him.²

Mufti Aḥmad Yār Khan al-Na‘īmī رحمه الله عليه says:

From this, we learn that Allah gives all religious and worldly blessings, such as knowledge, faith, wealth, and children, while the noble Prophet ﷺ distributes them. Whatever anyone received, they received it through the hands of the holy Prophet ﷺ. This is because

there is no limit to what Allah gives and no limit to what the holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ distributes. Therefore, it is a wrong idea that he only distributes knowledge. If this were true, it would mean that Allah also only grants knowledge.³

While explaining this hadith, some scholars have only mentioned “knowledge” regarding the distribution. However, this distribution is not limited only to knowledge. Many leading scholars have kept this distribution general. They believe that whether it is knowledge or wealth, the beloved Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ distributes every blessing.

A scholar from the fifth century AH, the commentator of Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī, Imam Ibn Baṭṭāl al-Mālikī رَحْمَةُ اللهِ عَلَيْهِ says:

This statement of the final Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ: **إِنَّمَا أَنَا قَاسِمٌ**, shows that the holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ did not keep any wealth for himself. Instead, he would distribute it among the noble Companions رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهُمْ. This statement was made to comfort the people — meaning that if someone receives more or less, it is the bestowal of Allah. If I (the Prophet) give more to someone, it is because Allah has decided it, and if I give less to someone, it is also because Allah has decided it.⁴

The great scholar of Hadith, Ḥāfiẓ Ibn Ḥajar al-Haytamī al-Makkī رَحْمَةُ اللهِ عَلَيْهِ, who passed away in the tenth century AH, states:

The holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ is the greatest vicegerent of Allah. Allah has placed the treasures of His grace and the banquets of His blessings in the hands of the holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ. The noble Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ may give whatever he wishes to whomever he wishes.⁵

For more details, it would be highly beneficial to read the following books of Imam Aḥmad Razā Khān رَحْمَةُ اللهِ عَلَيْهِ: *al-Amnu wa al-ʿUlā*⁶ and *Tajallī al-Yaqīn*⁷

¹ Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī, vol. 1, p. 42, hadith: 71

² Fatāwā Shāriḥ al-Bukhārī, vol. 1, p. 351

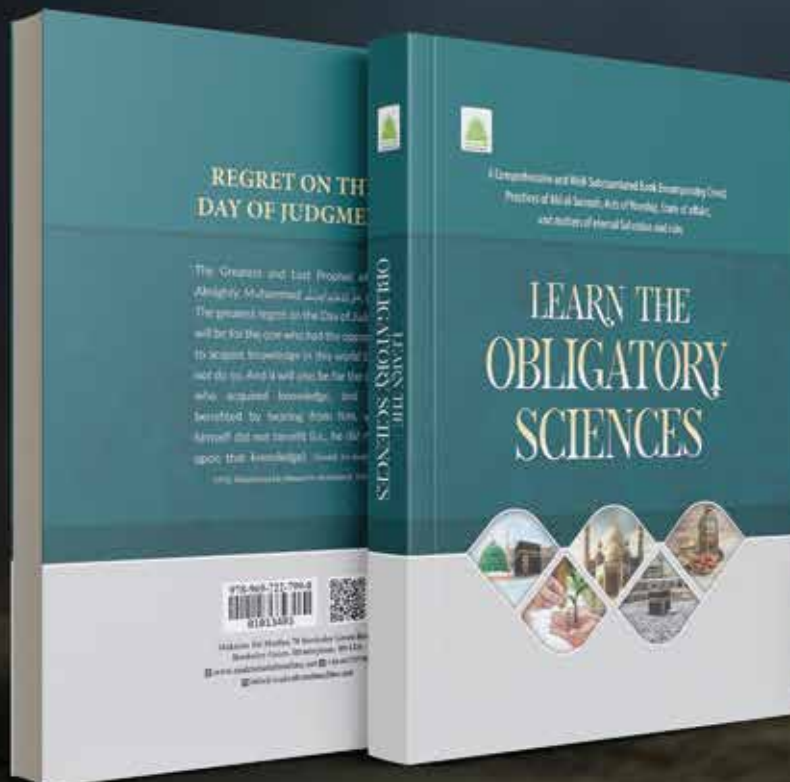
³ Mir'āt al-Manājīḥ, vol. 1, p. 177

⁴ Sharḥ Ibn Baṭṭāl 'alā Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī, vol. 1, p. 141 Summary

⁵ Al-Jawhar al-Munazzam, p. 80

⁶ Al-Fatāwā al-Riḍawiyyah, vol. 30, p. 359

⁷ Al-Fatāwā al-Riḍawiyyah, vol. 30, p. 129



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Laws of Trade

Selling an Item More Expensive Than the Market Rate

Question: What do the scholars of Islam say regarding the following matter: If a person sells an item to someone at three times the market rate without any deception, will the buyer have the right to cancel the deal once he finds out the actual price?

الْجَوَابُ بِعَوْنِ الْمَلِكِ الْوَهَّابِ اللَّهُمَّ هِدَايَةَ الْحَقِّ وَالصَّوَابِ

Answer: In the situation described, if the seller did not use any kind of deception while selling the item at three times the market rate, the buyer cannot cancel this deal, as it was made with mutual consent. However, if there was deception, the buyer can cancel the deal.

The scholars of Islamic law give an example of deception: For instance, a seller tells a buyer, "The price of my goods is this much," or "My goods are worth this much." Relying on the seller's words, the buyer buys the item. Later, he finds out that the seller was not telling the truth and the price of the item is actually much lower. Because of this deception by the seller, the buyer can return the item, provided that his right to return it has not ended due to some other reason stipulated by Shariah.

It is stated in *Tabyīn al-Haqā'iq*:

When the seller says to the buyer: "The price of my goods is this much," or says: "My goods are equal to this value," and the buyer purchases it based on this, but the reality is different, then the buyer will

have the right to cancel this sale because the seller deceived him. If the seller did not say anything like that, the buyer does not have the right to cancel the sale. Some scholars have said that no matter how the sale happened, it cannot be cancelled, but the correct view is that if there was deception, the ruling to return the item will be given; otherwise, it will not.¹

The erudite Hanafi jurist, Mufti Muhammad Amjad 'Alī al-A'zamī رَحْمَةُ الْمَلِكِ عَلَيْهِ states:

There are two situations if something is bought with *Ghabn Fāḥish* (excessive profiteering). Either the person was harmed through deception or not. If there is both *Ghabn Fāḥish* and deception, the item can be returned; otherwise, it cannot. *Ghabn Fāḥish* means a loss that is beyond the estimation of appraisers. For example, an item is bought for ten rupees, but one appraiser says its price is five, another says six, and another says seven; this is *Ghabn-e-Fāḥish*. However, if one valuer says its price is eight, another says nine, and another says ten, then this is *Ghabn Yasīr* (slight profiteering).

There are three ways of deception:

1. Sometimes the seller deceives the buyer and sells a five-rupee item for ten.
2. Sometimes the buyer deceives the seller and buys a ten-rupee item for five.
3. Sometimes a broker (the one who arranges the deal) deceives someone.

In these three cases, the person who suffered a

loss due to *Ghabn-e-Fāhish* can return the item. However, if a complete stranger deceived the person, the item cannot be returned.²

وَاللَّهُ أَعْلَمُ عَزَّ وَجَلَّ وَرَسُولُهُ أَعْلَمُ صَلَّى اللَّهُ تَعَالَى عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ

What is the ruling on selling gold for gold?

Question: What do the scholars of Islam say regarding the following matter: Our work involves making gold jewellery and selling it to shopkeepers. Our method is that when we sell gold, we take gold in return. For example, if we sell ten tolas of gold (as jewellery) to a shopkeeper, we take ten tolas of gold back. However, the shopkeeper gives one tola of gold on the spot and defers the remaining gold on credit. Is it permissible to make a contract like this?

The detail of this is that the shopkeeper buys jewellery from the workshop owner, and that jewellery is not 24 Karat, but the gold he gives back in exchange is 24 Karat.

الْجَوَابُ بِعَوْنِ الْمَلِكِ الْوَهَّابِ اللَّهُمَّ هِدَايَةَ الْحَقِّ وَالصَّوَابِ

This contract is not only impermissible but is a clear matter of *ribā* (usury). Doing this is forbidden (haram), and the income gained from it is *ribā* and haram wealth. In the blessed hadith, it is stated that when you sell gold, sell it then and there and in equal amounts. However, your matter is the opposite, as gold is being sold for gold on credit; therefore, it is a clear matter of *ribā*.

It is stated in the blessed Hadith:

عَنْ أَبِي سَعِيدٍ الْخُدْرِيِّ قَالَ قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ: الذَّهَبُ بِالذَّهَبِ، وَالْفِضَّةُ بِالْفِضَّةِ، وَالْبُرُّ بِالْبُرِّ، وَالشَّعِيرُ بِالشَّعِيرِ، وَالتَّمْرُ بِالتَّمْرِ، وَالْبَلَحُ بِالْبَلَحِ، مَثَلًا يَمْتَلِكُ، يَدَا يَمِينٍ، فَمَنْ زَادَ، أَوْ اسْتَرَادَ، فَقَدْ أَرَبَى، أَلَا خِدُّو الْمُعْطَى فِيهِ سَوَاءٌ

ترجمہ اللہ عنہ رضي الله عنه Sayyidunā Abū Saʿīd al-Khudrī narrates that the merciful Prophet صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ stated:

Gold for gold, silver for silver, wheat for wheat, barley for barley, dates for dates, and salt for salt—must be sold in equal amounts and there and then. So, whoever gave more or took more has indeed dealt in *ribā*. In this matter, the one who takes and the one who gives are both equal.³

Mufti Amjad ‘Alī al-A‘zamī رَحْمَةُ اللَّهِ عَلَيْهِ writes:

If silver is sold for silver or gold for gold—meaning the items on both sides are of the same type—then the condition is that both must be equal in weight and physical possession must take place then and there in the same session. This means each person must take possession of the other's item by their own action. If the people making the deal did not take possession by hand, but suppose they placed their item there after the contract and walked away with the other person's item, this is not enough. Doing this makes the sale impermissible; in fact, it becomes *ribā*.⁴

وَاللَّهُ أَعْلَمُ عَزَّ وَجَلَّ وَرَسُولُهُ أَعْلَمُ صَلَّى اللَّهُ تَعَالَى عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ

An Important Matter Regarding Online Buying and Selling

Question: What do the scholars of Islam say regarding the following matter: While advertising items, pictures of the products are first posted on the internet. After seeing and liking them, the buying and selling take place, and then the customer pays the amount online. Sometimes, the item being sold is not in the ownership of the advertiser until the deal is made. However, after the deal is made, he buys it from someone else and sends it to the person who had already paid the money. What is the ruling on this?

الْجَوَابُ بِعَوْنِ الْمَلِكِ الْوَهَّابِ اللَّهُمَّ هِدَايَةَ الْحَقِّ وَالصَّوَابِ

If it is truly the case that the item is not in the seller's ownership at the time of the deal, then making such a deal is not permissible. It is stated in *al-Durr al-Mukhtār*: “كُلُّ مَا أَوْرَثَ خِلَافِي رُكْنِ الْبَيْعِ فَهُوَ مُبْطِلٌ” meaning, “Every such thing that causes a flaw in the pillar of the sale makes the sale void.”⁵

While mentioning the conditions of a sale in *Radd al-Muhtār*, Imam al-Shāmī رَحْمَةُ اللَّهِ عَلَيْهِ states:

كَوْلُهُ مُؤْجِدًا مَالًا مُتَقَوِّمًا مَمْلُوكًا فِي نَفْسِهِ، وَكَوْنُ الْمَلِكِ لِلْبَائِعِ فِيهَا يَبْتِغِيهِ لِنَفْسِهِ

This means: “It is necessary for the item being sold to exist, to be *māl mutaqaawwim*,⁶ to be owned in its own right, and that ownership of what is being sold belongs to the seller himself.”⁷

Mufti Amjad Ali al-A‘zamī رَحْمَةُ اللَّهِ عَلَيْهِ states in *Bahār-e-Shariat*: “The ruling on a void sale is that even

Mufti Amjad Ali al-A'zamī رَحْمَةُ اللهِ عَلَيْهِ states in *Bahār-e-Shariat*: "The ruling on a void sale is that even if the buyer takes possession of the item, he will still not become its owner. That possession by the buyer will be considered a possession of trust (*amānah*)."⁸

There are further concerns regarding the mentioned deal, but since the question was received via email, it is not possible to comment on the remaining matters without knowing the specific details.

وَاللّٰهُ اَعْلَمُ عَزَّوَجَلَّ وَرَسُوْلُهُ اَعْلَمُ صَلَّى اللّٰهُ تَعَالٰى عَلَيْهِ وَاٰلِهٖ وَسَلَّم

It is Not Permissible to Get a Haircut Without Fixing the Price

Question: What do the scholars of Islam say regarding the following matter: Zayd got a haircut from a non-Muslim barber but did not fix the price beforehand. After the haircut, Zayd gave some money to the barber, and the barber took it silently. My question is, is it correct to do this?

اَلْجَوَابُ بِحَوْنِ الْمَلِكِ الْوَهَّابِ اَللّٰهُمَّ هِدَايَةَ الْحَقِّ وَالصَّوَابِ

Answer: It is not permissible to get a haircut without fixing the price. This is because the rule is that when you take permissible services from someone that

require payment—such as getting the hair cut—and the payment is not fixed, it is not permissible. In such a case, the *ujrat-e-mithl* must be given, which means the standard market rate for that work. However, if the rates are already well-known or both parties are aware of the rates, then it is not necessary to fix the rate every time.

Nevertheless, in the situation mentioned, the contract was made with a non-Muslim; therefore, this action will not be called impermissible in any way, as corrupt contracts (*'uqūd fāsidah*) between a Muslim and a *ḥarbī* non-Muslim are permissible.

وَاللّٰهُ اَعْلَمُ عَزَّوَجَلَّ وَرَسُوْلُهُ اَعْلَمُ صَلَّى اللّٰهُ تَعَالٰى عَلَيْهِ وَاٰلِهٖ وَسَلَّم

¹ *Tabyīn al-Ḥaqā'iq*, vol. 4, p. 436

² *Bahar-e-Shariat*, vol. 2, p. 691

³ *Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim*, p. 659, Hadith: 4064

⁴ *Bahar-e-Shariat*, vol. 2, p. 821

⁵ *Radd al-Muḥtār 'alā al-Durr al-Mukhtār*, vol. 7, p. 233

⁶ Such wealth that can be gathered and from which it is permissible to take benefit, according to the Shariah. (*Radd-ul-Muḥtār*, vol. 7, p. 8)

⁷ *Radd al-Muḥtār 'alā al-Durr al-Mukhtār*, vol. 7, p. 13

⁸ *Bahār-e-Shariat*, vol. 2, p. 701



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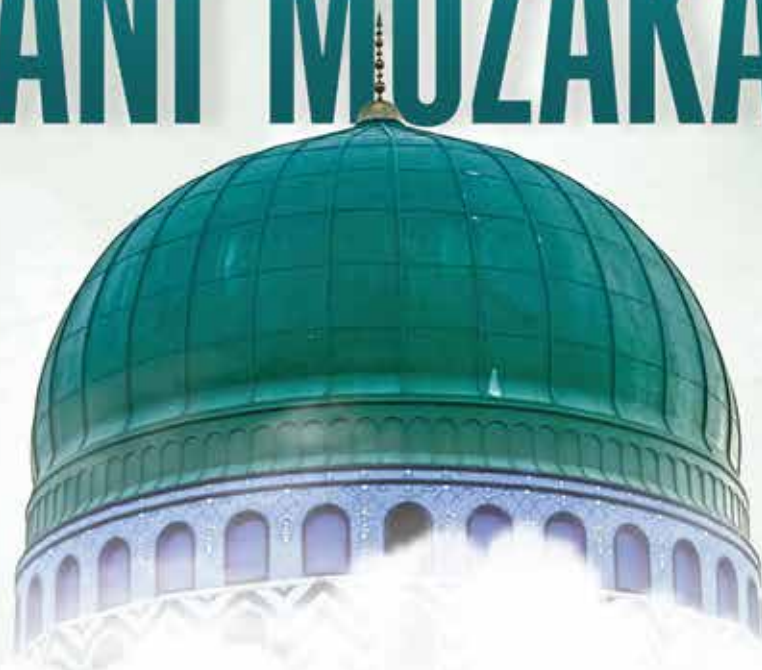
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Questions and Answers from MADANI MUZAKARAH



Is it allowed for children to play with dolls and teddy bears?

Question: Is it allowed for children to play with dolls, teddy bears and similar toys?

Answer: Yes, it is permissible for children to play with dolls and teddy bears. However, it is not allowed to display them in places of respect, such as in a cupboard, a display cabinet, or on a high shelf. If they are displayed this way, the angels of mercy will not enter the house. These toys should just be left lying around or kept in a scattered manner. They should not be used as decorations. If someone has decorated their display cabinet with these items, they should repent. Instead of toys, you can put beautiful flower vases in the display cabinet. You may also keep toy cars or aeroplanes, as long as they do not have pictures of living things on them.

وَاللَّهُ أَكْبَرُ وَرَسُولُهُ أَكْبَرُ عَزَّ وَجَلَّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ تَعَالَى عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ
صَلُّوا عَلَى الْحَبِيبِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ

Can a person who dies under the weight of something be called a martyr?

Question: If a person dies because something falls on

them and crushes them, can we call them a martyr?

Answer: Yes. If a Muslim dies by being crushed under something, like a wall, a large stone, or iron, they are a martyr.

وَاللَّهُ أَكْبَرُ وَرَسُولُهُ أَكْبَرُ عَزَّ وَجَلَّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ تَعَالَى عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ
صَلُّوا عَلَى الْحَبِيبِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ

Should we only fast on the 10th of Muharram?

Question: Can we fast on the 9th or 11th of Muharram along with the 10th, or should we only fast on the 10th?

Answer: You can fast on the 9th or 11th of Muharram along with the 10th. In fact, this is what we are taught in the hadith. As mentioned in *Musnad Imam Ahmad*, the holy Prophet صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ said: "Fast on the Day of 'Āshūrā and go against the way of the Jews; fast one day before it or one day after it."¹

وَاللَّهُ أَكْبَرُ وَرَسُولُهُ أَكْبَرُ عَزَّ وَجَلَّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ تَعَالَى عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ
صَلُّوا عَلَى الْحَبِيبِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ

Is it okay to say "Go to the furnace" (Bhaar mein ja)?

Question: Is it okay to use the phrase "Bhaar mein ja"?

Answer: The word "Bhaar" refers to a large stove or furnace. Phrases like "Bhaar mein ja" or "Bhaar mein gaya" are said to show that you think someone is lowly or unimportant. These words hurt people's feelings. Naturally, when you say such things to someone, they will feel upset. Instead of reducing hatred, such words increase it. Therefore, one should avoid using such phrases because hurting someone's feelings can lead a person to Hell.

وَاللَّهُ أَكْبَرُ وَرَسُولُهُ أَكْبَرُ عَزَّ وَجَلَّ وَصَلَّى اللَّهُ تَعَالَى عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ
صَلُّوا عَلَى الْحَبِيبِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ

The ruling on water coming out of the mouth while sleeping

Question: If water comes out of someone's mouth while they are sleeping at night, is it pure or impure?

Answer: For some people, water without froth comes out of their mouth while sleeping. For some, it even happens while they are awake. People usually call this drool, and it is actually saliva. Whether it smells or not, it is pure.²

وَاللَّهُ أَكْبَرُ وَرَسُولُهُ أَكْبَرُ عَزَّ وَجَلَّ وَصَلَّى اللَّهُ تَعَالَى عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ
صَلُّوا عَلَى الْحَبِيبِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ

The four kings who ruled the whole world

Question: Has there ever been a king who ruled over the entire world?

Answer: There have been four kings who ruled the entire world. Two of them were Muslim: (1) Prophet Sulaymān عَلَيْهِ السَّلَام and (2) Sayyidunā Sikandar Dhū al-Qarnayn عَلَيْهِ السَّلَام. The other two were non-believers: (3) Nimrod and (4) Nebuchadnezzar.³

وَاللَّهُ أَكْبَرُ وَرَسُولُهُ أَكْبَرُ عَزَّ وَجَلَّ وَصَلَّى اللَّهُ تَعَالَى عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ
صَلُّوا عَلَى الْحَبِيبِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ

Should we pray the Funeral Prayer with shoes on or off?

Question: Should we pray the funeral prayer while wearing shoes or after taking them off? Also, some people take off their shoes and stand on top of them to pray; is this okay?

Answer: If you offer the funeral prayer while wearing your shoes, then both the shoes and the ground must

be pure. If you take off your shoes and stand on top of them, then it is not necessary for the soles of the shoes or the ground to be pure. The Imam of Ahl al-Sunnah, Imam Ahmad Riḍā Khān عَلَيْهِ رَحْمَةُ اللَّهِ عَلَيْهِ says in answer to a question: "If the place was impure due to urine or if the soles of the shoes were impure, and the prayer was offered while wearing those shoes, then the prayer is not valid. It is safer to take off the shoes and stand on top of them so that if the ground or the soles are impure, the prayer is not affected."⁴

(To learn more about the rules of the funeral prayer and other prayers, please read the book "Laws of Salah (Hanafi)" published by Maktaba-tul-Madina.)

وَاللَّهُ أَكْبَرُ وَرَسُولُهُ أَكْبَرُ عَزَّ وَجَلَّ وَصَلَّى اللَّهُ تَعَالَى عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ
صَلُّوا عَلَى الْحَبِيبِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ

The best time to ask Allah Almighty for forgiveness

Question: What is the best time to ask Allah Almighty for forgiveness?

Answer: If a person commits a sin due to human weakness, it is necessary (*wājib*) to repent immediately. The best time to ask Allah Almighty for forgiveness is to repent as soon as the sin is committed.

وَاللَّهُ أَكْبَرُ وَرَسُولُهُ أَكْبَرُ عَزَّ وَجَلَّ وَصَلَّى اللَّهُ تَعَالَى عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ
صَلُّوا عَلَى الْحَبِيبِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ

Is it allowed to eat duck?

Question: Is it Halal to eat a duck?

Answer: Yes, it is Halal to eat a duck.⁵ It should also be slaughtered by reciting بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الْكَبِيرِ.

وَاللَّهُ أَكْبَرُ وَرَسُولُهُ أَكْبَرُ عَزَّ وَجَلَّ وَصَلَّى اللَّهُ تَعَالَى عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ
صَلُّوا عَلَى الْحَبِيبِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ

"I wish I were in the era of the holy Prophet ﷺ"

Question: Is it okay to say, "I wish I were in the era of the holy Prophet صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ so I could see him"?

Answer: There is no harm in having this wish. We can wish that we were born in the blessed era of the beloved Prophet صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ and stayed close to his feet. However, this wish should include being a person of faith. This is because Abū Jahl was also present in that blessed era, but he gained no benefit

and died as a non-believer.

وَاللَّهُ أَكْبَرُ وَرَسُولُهُ أَكْبَرُ عَزَّ وَجَلَّ وَصَلَّى اللَّهُ تَعَالَى عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ
صَلُّوا عَلَى الْحَبِيبِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ

How is it to desire hearing one's own praise?

Question: Is it okay to have a desire to hear people praise you?

Answer: It is not good to want to hear your own praise; there is a lot of risk in it. The beloved Prophet صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ said, "Liking your own praise makes a person blind and deaf."⁶ It is very difficult to control the carnal-self (*nafs*) after hearing praise and admiration from people. Therefore, one should try to avoid hearing their own praise.

However, if a person does not have a desire for it, but someone praises them anyway, there is no harm in hearing lawful praise as long as the person keeps their *nafs* under control. For example, whilst in their presence, people praised the pious predecessors رَجَمَهُمُ اللَّهُ and recited poems in their honour, but these great personalities did not stop them from doing this.

In this regard, here is an account:

The representative of Imam Aḥmad Riḍā Khān, the preacher of Islam, Mawlana ‘Abd al-‘Alim al-Ṣiddiqī al-Mirṭhī رَحِمَهُ اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ, once visited Imam Aḥmad Riḍā Khān رَحِمَهُ اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ after returning from the two Harams. He recited an ode in praise of the Imam رَحِمَهُ اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ in a very beautiful voice. Imam Aḥmad Riḍā Khān رَحِمَهُ اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ did not show any sign of aversion. Instead, he said, "Mawlana! What can I present to you?" Pointing towards his very expensive *‘imāmah*, he said, "If I give you this *‘imāmah*, it is not even worthy of your feet because you are coming from that pure land. However, the most expensive item among my clothes is a cloak (*jubbah*); I present that to you." He then brought a red velvet cloak from his home and gave it to him. Its value was at least 150 rupees (which was a lot at that time). The Mawlana stood up, spread both his hands, and took it. He touched it to his eyes, kissed it, placed it on his head, and held it to his chest for a long time.⁷

وَاللَّهُ أَكْبَرُ وَرَسُولُهُ أَكْبَرُ عَزَّ وَجَلَّ وَصَلَّى اللَّهُ تَعَالَى عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ
صَلُّوا عَلَى الْحَبِيبِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ

How can we please the beloved Prophet ﷺ?

Question: What should we do in the month of Rabī‘ al-Awwal to please the beloved Prophet صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ?

Answer: We should please the Beloved Prophet صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ in Rabī‘ al-Awwal and in every other month too. We must always do the things that please Allah Almighty and the merciful Prophet صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ. If someone was lazy in their prayers, they should stop being lazy. If they have missed prayers from the past, they should repent, calculate them, and start making them up immediately.

In the same way, while celebrating the birth of the holy Prophet (*Mawlid*), one should ensure they are fulfilling their obligatory (*fard*) and necessary (*wājib*) duties like fasting and Zakat. We should also follow the Sunnah in our lives. For example, instead of having stylish hairstyles, one should keep long hair according to the Sunnah. Instead of walking around with a bare head, one should wear the *‘imāmah*. If someone shaves their beard or trims it to less than a handful, they should repent and adorn their face with a Sunnah-length beard. One should also dress according to the Sunnah and adopt a complete Islamic appearance. Change your laziness into active effort for those *sunan* you were neglecting. Spend your life doing things that please Allah Almighty. إِنَّ رِشَاءَ اللَّهِ a positive transformation will take place in your heart.

وَاللَّهُ أَكْبَرُ وَرَسُولُهُ أَكْبَرُ عَزَّ وَجَلَّ وَصَلَّى اللَّهُ تَعَالَى عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ
صَلُّوا عَلَى الْحَبِيبِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ

¹ Musnad Imam Aḥmad, vol. 1, p. 518, hadith: 2154

² Extracted from al-Fatāwā al-Riḍāwiyyah, 1-A/352

³ Sāwī, vol. vol. 4, p. 1216, P. 16, Surah al-Kahf: below verse: 83

⁴ Al-Fatāwā al-Riḍāwiyyah, 9/188

⁵ Tafsirāt Aḥmadiyyah, Juz’ 8, Surah al-An‘ām, below verse: 146, p. 405.

⁶ Firdaws al-Akḥbār, vol. 1, p. 347, hadith: 2548

⁷ Hayat-e-Ala Hazrat, vol. 1, pp. 132-134 summarized

Rulings for Islamic Sisters

Is it allowed for sisters to waive their share of inheritance?

Question: What do the scholars of Islam regarding the following matter: Our father left half a house as inheritance. We are two brothers and four sisters. Our sisters have "forgiven" (waived) their share of the inheritance for us. In this case, will the sisters' share cease or not?

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ
الْجَوَابُ بِعَوْنِ الْمَلِكِ الْوَهَّابِ اَللّٰهُمَّ هِدَايَةَ الْحَقِّ وَالصَّوَابِ

Answer: The right of heirs to inheritance is fixed by Allah Almighty. A person's share is not cancelled simply by them saying they "leave it," "step away from it," or "forgive it." However, it can happen in this way: the brothers, with mutual agreement, give their sisters some money as a settlement in exchange for their share. It does not matter if this amount is less or more than the value of their actual share. If the sisters accept this, the money will become the replacement for their share, and their right to the house will end.

Furthermore, if the sisters do not want to take anything and want to give the inheritance to their brothers, they can do the following: first, they should divide the house

and take possession of their share. After that, they can give it as a gift to whichever brother they choose. Another way is to sell their share to the brothers at a fixed price before taking possession of it and then waive the owed amount.

وَاللّٰهُ اَعْلَمُ عَزَّوَجَلَّ وَرَسُوْلُهُ اَعْلَمُ صَلَّى اللّٰهُ تَعَالٰى عَلَيْهِ وَاٰلِهٖ وَسَلَّم

Answered by: Abu Saeed Muhammad Naveed Raza al-Attari

Verified by: Muhammad Fuzail Raza al-Attari

To what extent can a woman adorn herself?

Question: What do the scholars of Islam say regarding the following matters: (1) Is it allowed for a woman to cut her hair, sometimes below the shoulders and sometimes above the shoulders, only to look beautiful for her husband? (2) To what extent is a woman allowed to wear makeup for her husband? (3) How much adornment is allowed for an unmarried young woman?



بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

الْجَوَابُ بِعَوْنِ الْمَلِكِ الْوَهَّابِ اللَّهُمَّ هِدَايَةَ الْحَقِّ وَالصَّوَابِ

Answer: (1) It is not allowed and it is haram to cut the hair above the shoulders because this is imitating men. If the husband is happy with this, he is also a sinner. However, there is no harm in trimming the ends of the hair below the shoulders.

(2) It is permissible and recommended (*mustahabb*) for a woman to adorn herself for her husband, as long as she uses halal things within the limits of Shariah. Imam Aḥmad Riḍā Khan رَحْمَةُ اللَّهِ عَلَيْهِ states: "For a woman to wear jewellery and adorn herself for her husband brings a great reward. In her case, it is better than offering *nafl* (voluntary) prayers. Some pious women, who were saints themselves and whose husbands were also saints, would dress up completely like a bride every night after the 'Ishā' prayer and go to their husbands. If the husband needed them, they would stay. Otherwise, they would take off the jewellery and clothes, spread the prayer mat, and busy themselves in prayer. Decorating a bride is an ancient Sunnah and is proven by many *aḥādīth*."

(3) An unmarried girl can also use makeup and similar things made from halal items within the limits of Shariah. Imam Aḥmad Riḍā Khan رَحْمَةُ اللَّهِ عَلَيْهِ states: "In fact, it is a Sunnah to keep unmarried girls adorned with jewellery and good clothes so that they receive marriage proposals. It is disliked (*makrūh*) for a woman to stay completely without jewellery when she has the means, as this is imitating men." Sayyida-tunā 'Ā'ishah al-Ṣiddīqah رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهَا used to consider it disliked for a woman to pray without jewellery. She used to say that if she has nothing else, she should at least tie a thread around her neck.

Note: It is not permissible for women to trim or shape their eyebrows.

وَاللَّهُ أَعْلَمُ عَزَّوَجَلَّ وَرَسُولُهُ أَعْلَمُ صَلَّى اللَّهُ تَعَالَى عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ

Answered by: Abu Ahmad Muhammad Anas Raza Attari

Verified by: Muhammad Hashim Khan al-Attari al-Madani

A Muslim woman getting a check-up from a non-Muslim woman

Question: What do the scholars of Islam say regarding the following matter: In the UK, when a woman is in labour, the doctor for the delivery is usually a non-Muslim woman. In these circumstances, can a Muslim woman reveal her body to a non-Muslim female doctor?

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

الْجَوَابُ بِعَوْنِ الْمَلِكِ الْوَهَّابِ اللَّهُمَّ هِدَايَةَ الْحَقِّ وَالصَّوَابِ

Answer: In the situation mentioned, it is not allowed for a Muslim woman to have a delivery performed by a non-Muslim woman or to expose her private region (*satr*) before her. This is because a Muslim woman must observe the same veil from a non-Muslim woman as she does from a strange man. This means the parts of the body that are not allowed to be exposed before a strange man are also not allowed to be exposed before a non-Muslim woman.

However, if there is a real emergency and a Muslim midwife is not available, then in a state of extreme necessity, the services of a non-Muslim woman can be taken.

Muslims living in such countries should plan ahead and keep hospitals in mind where Muslim lady doctors, nurses, and midwives are available. This is so that they can go to such hospitals immediately when needed and do not have to show their private parts to a non-Muslim.

وَاللَّهُ أَعْلَمُ عَزَّوَجَلَّ وَرَسُولُهُ أَعْلَمُ صَلَّى اللَّهُ تَعَالَى عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ

Answered by: Muhammad Sajid al-Attari al-Madani

Verified by: Muhammad Hashim Khan al-Attari al-Madani

Questioner: Fayyaz-ur-Rahman, Hyderabad

Al-Fatāwā al-Riḍawīyah, vol. 22, p. 126

Al-Fatāwā al-Riḍawīyah, vol. 22, p. 128

THE BLESSED SONS AND BLESSED DAUGHTERS OF THE BELOVED PROPHET ﷺ

Dear Islamic brothers! Allah Almighty blessed the merciful Prophet ﷺ with three sons and four daughters. A brief introduction to them is as follows:

Sayyidunā Qāsim رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

He was born to the Mother of the Believers, Sayyidah Khadijah رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهَا, before the declaration of Prophethood. The teknonym of the holy Prophet ﷺ, 'Abū al-Qāsim', is based on his name. According to the majority of scholars, he had learned to walk by the time he passed away.¹

Sayyidunā 'Abdullāh رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

He was born in Makkah al-Mukarramah before the declaration of Prophethood and passed away during his childhood. 'Ṭayyib' and 'Ṭāhir' are his titles.²

Sayyidunā Ibrāhīm رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

He was the youngest son. He was born in *Dhū al-Hijjah* 8 AH at a place called 'Āliyah' near Madinah al-Munawwarah. His mother was Sayyidah Māriyah al-Qibṭiyyah رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهَا. He passed away at the age of 17 or 18 months on the 10th of *Rabī' al-Awwal* 10 AH.³

Sayyidah Zaynab رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهَا

She was the eldest daughter. She was born in Makkah al-Mukarramah ten years before the declaration of Prophethood. She passed away in the 8th year after the *Hijrah*.⁴

Sayyidah Ruqayyah رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهَا

She was born seven years before the declaration of Prophethood. She was the wife of Sayyidunā 'Uthmān b.

'Affān رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ. She passed away at the age of twenty on the 19th of Ramadan 2 AH, three days after the victory at Badr.⁵

Sayyidah Umm Kulthūm رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهَا

After the passing of Sayyidah Ruqayyah رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهَا, she was married to Sayyidunā 'Uthmān b. 'Affān رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ in *Rabī' al-Awwal* 3 AH. She passed away in *Sha'bān* 9 AH.⁶

Sayyidah Fāṭimah رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهَا

She was the youngest, most beloved, and dearly cherished daughter of the greatest Prophet ﷺ. She was married to Sayyidunā 'Alī al-Murtaḍā رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ in 2 AH. The noble *Sādāt* (descendants of the holy Prophet) throughout the world today are the descendants of her sons, Sayyidunā Imam Ḥasan and Sayyidunā Imam Ḥusayn رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا. She left this temporary world on the 3rd of Ramadan 11 AH, six months after the holy Prophet ﷺ passed away.⁷

May Allah Almighty be pleased with them and grant us forgiveness without accountability for their sake.

أَمِينَ بِجَاهِ خَاتَمِ النَّبِيِّينَ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ

¹ Al-Zurqānī 'alā al-Mawāhib, vol. 4, p. 316

² Ibid.

³ Madārij al-Nubuwwah, vol. 2, pp. 452-453; Sirat Sayyid al-Anbiyā', p. 593

⁴ Al-Zurqānī 'alā al-Mawāhib, vol. 4, pp. 318-319 selected

⁵ Sirat-e-Muṣṭafā p. 694; Al-Zurqānī 'alā al-Mawāhib, vol. 4, pp. 322-324, extracted; Sirat Sayyid al-Anbiyā', p. 257

⁶ Al-Zurqānī 'alā al-Mawāhib, vol. 4, pp. 325-327 selected

⁷ Al-Zurqānī 'alā al-Mawāhib, vol. 4, pp. 333-337; Madārij al-Nubuwwah, vol. 2, p. 461 selected

The Leader of the Just, Sayyidunā 'Umar al-Fārūq al-A'zam رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

In the scorching heat of the Arabian desert, a person with a cloth over his head was walking towards Madinah al-Munawwarah رَادَّهَا اللَّهُ شَرْفًا وَتَعْظِيمًا. On the way, he saw a slave riding a donkey and said to him, "The heat is very intense; let me ride behind you." The slave recognised the man, immediately dismounted, and requested, "Please, you ride on it." However, the man replied, "You ride, and I will sit behind you." The slave insisted again, "Please ride, and I will walk," but the man did not agree. Finally, the slave let the man sit behind him. When both riders entered the boundaries of al-Madinah Munawwarah, people were looking at the man with astonishment.¹

Dear Islamic brothers! The one riding behind the slave was no ordinary man. He was the great personality who lit the lamps of guidance in cities steeped in disbelief. He crushed the pride of the Roman and Persian empires. During his reign, more than a thousand cities were conquered, and over four thousand masjids were built. This respected personality is the Leader of the Just, the Opposer of the Hypocrites, the Leader of the Believers, Sayyidunā 'Umar al-Fārūq al-A'zam رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ.

Teknonym, Title, and Appearance

His teknonym was 'Abū Ḥaṣṣ' and his title was 'al-Fārūq al-A'zam'. He was tall, strongly built, and fair complexioned,

with a thick and curly beard.² He رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ was born thirteen years after the Year of the Elephant, which corresponds to 583 AD. Both before and after embracing Islam, he was highly prominent among the nobles of the Quraish due to his personal and family status. During the days of ignorance, he served as a representative for the disbelievers of Makkah in several wars.³ According to one narration, he رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ embraced Islam in the sixth year after the declaration of Prophethood, following thirty-nine men, due to the supplication of the merciful Prophet صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ. Upon his acceptance of Islam, a wave of joy spread among the Muslims, to the extent that the disbelievers were forced to say, "Today our power has been cut in half."⁴

Life as a Warrior

He رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ fought the disbelievers with great courage in all battles and served as a commander in several campaigns. As a minister and advisor, he remained a loyal companion of the holy Prophet صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ and Sayyidunā Abū Bakr al-Ṣiddīq رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ in all Islamic matters and in the planning of peace and war.⁵

Luminous Character

The level of simplicity, piety, justice, and fear of Allah Almighty he رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ possessed was unique to him. Whether traveling or at home, privately or in

public, he lived his life with great simplicity. When he needed to rest, he would spread a cloth on the ground and lie on it. Sometimes, he would hang a cloth on a tree and rest in its shade.⁶ Once, when delivering a sermon, there were twelve patches on the cloth he was wearing.⁷

Removing Pride

Despite being the great leader of a vast empire, his humility was such that he was once seen carrying a water-skin filled with water on his shoulder. Someone remarked, "O Leader of the Believers! This work is not suitable for you." He replied, "Delegations of people come to me one after another, because of which I felt a wave of pride in my heart. Therefore, I wish to crush this wave by carrying this water-skin." Then he went to the house of an *Anṣārī* lady رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهَا and filled her containers with water.⁸

Fear of Allah Almighty and Worship

He رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ used to ask the children of Madinah al-Munawwarah to pray for him, saying, "Pray that 'Umar is forgiven."⁹ The words "اللَّهُ أَكْبَرُ" were often on his tongue.¹⁰ In the later part of his life, he started observing continuous fasts.¹¹

Era of Caliphate

He assumed the Caliphate in 13 AH and remained in this position for ten years and six months.

Accountability of his Son

The profound impact of the company and training of the holy Prophet صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ meant that he showed no leniency in implementing and following Islamic laws. Once, he saw a very fat camel being sold in the market and asked, "Whose camel is this?" People told him it belonged to his son. He immediately called his son and asked why the camel had become so fat. His son replied, "This camel grazes in the government pasture, which is why it has become so fat." He ordered, "Sell this camel, keep the normal price of a camel for yourself, and deposit the remaining amount into the public treasury."¹²

List of Assets

Whenever he appointed someone as a governor of a province, he had a record of all their wealth and assets written down and kept with him. Later, if the assets of any official increased (and they could not give a valid reason for it), he would order those assets to be deposited into the public treasury.¹³ He رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ himself used to say, "People remain on the right path as long as their leaders and heads remain on the right path."¹⁴

Importance of Ṣalāh

He رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ gave more importance to Ṣalāh than anything else. He sent an order to the governors of all his provinces, stating, "In my view, Ṣalāh is the most important of all your works. Whoever protects the prayer and is regular in it has protected his religion, and whoever wastes it will waste other matters too."¹⁵

Martyrdom

The life of this great ruler is recorded in world history as a supreme example of honour, nobility, and greatness. On the morning of the 26th of *Dhū al-Hijjah al-Ḥarām*, a Persian slave named Abū Lu'lu' Fayrūz attacked him during the *Fajr* prayer, wounding him severely. He رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ ordered Sayyidunā 'Abd al-Raḥmān b. 'Awf رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ to lead the prayer. When people carried him to his home, he had already lost consciousness due to continuous blood loss. As soon as he regained consciousness, he held his son's hand, made him sit behind him, performed *wuḍū'*, and offered the *Fajr* prayer.

After spending a few days in a severely injured state, he surrendered his soul to the Creator. Sayyidunā Ṣuhayb رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ led his funeral prayer. He رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ was laid to rest on the 1st of *Muḥarram al-Ḥarām* 24 AH in the sacred chamber of the holy Prophet صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ, beside the first Caliph, Sayyidunā al-Ṣiddīq al-Akbar رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ.¹⁶ At the time of martyrdom, his blessed age was 63 years. The number of *aḥādīth* narrated by him is 537.

Request: To read the detailed life and achievements of Sayyidunā al-Fārūq al-A'zam رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ, study the book published by Maktabat-ul-Madinah: *Faizan-e-Farooq-e-Azam* رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ (two volumes).

¹ Tārikh Ibn 'Asākir, vol. 44, p. 318, summarised

² Faizan-e-Farooq-e-Azam, vol. 1, pp. 59-60

³ Tārikh al-Khulafā', p. 99, summarised

⁴ Al-Durr al-Manthūr, vol. 4, p. 487, Juz' 10, Surah Al-Anfal: under verse 67

⁵ Tārikh Ibn 'Asākir, vol. 44, p. 54, vol. 2, p. 67; Al-Riyāḍ al-Naḍirah, vol. 1, p. 335, summarised

⁶ Faizan-e-Farooq-e-Azam, vol. 1, p. 64, summarised

⁷ Al-Zuhd li Imam Aḥmad, p. 152

⁸ Al-Risālah al-Qushayriyyah, p. 185

⁹ Fazaail-e-Dua, p. 112

¹⁰ Al-Riyāḍ al-Naḍirah, vol. 1, p. 364

¹¹ Al-Riyāḍ al-Naḍirah, vol. 1, p. 363

¹² Tārikh Ibn 'Asākir, vol. 44, p. 326, summarised

¹³ Futūḥ al-Buldān, p. 307

¹⁴ Ṭabaqāt Ibn Sa'd, vol. 3, p. 222

¹⁵ Muwaṭṭa' Imam Mālik, vol. 1, p. 35, hadith: 6

¹⁶ Ṭabaqāt Ibn Sa'd, vol. 3, pp. 266, 280, 281; Tārikh Ibn 'Asākir, vol. 44, pp. 422, 464

The Holy Prophet's ﷺ Compassion for Children

Asif Jahanzeb Attari Madani

The Holy Prophet ﷺ came as a mercy for all the worlds. Just like adults, children also received a large share of the mercy of the beloved Prophet ﷺ. The merciful Prophet ﷺ showed immense kindness to children. He would call them to him, stroke their heads with his hand of mercy, and bless them with supplications for goodness and success. Here are some examples:

01 The mother of Sayyidunā ‘Abdullāh b. Hishām رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ brought him to the presence of the holy Prophet ﷺ. The Holy Prophet ﷺ stroked his head with his hand of kindness and blessed him with a supplication for blessings.¹

02 The holy Prophet ﷺ used to make children happy by being cheerful and playful with them. It is narrated that the younger brother of Sayyidunā Anas رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ had a small bird. When that bird died, the holy Prophet ﷺ visited their home and asked, "What happened to Abū ‘Umair?" The people replied, "His bird has died." The Holy Prophet ﷺ jokingly began to say to him, "O Abū ‘Umair! How is your bird? O Abū ‘Umair! How is your bird?"²

03 Whenever the holy Prophet ﷺ returned from a journey, he would let children sit with him on his mount.³

04 When a child was born and brought to the court of the noble Prophet ﷺ, he would bless the child with a supplication for blessings and perform *tahnik* himself (this means he would chew a small piece of a date and put it into the baby's mouth).⁴

05 Furthermore, whenever the merciful Prophet ﷺ heard the sound of a child crying during congregational prayer, he would shorten the prayer.⁵

(Footnotes)

¹ Al-Iṣābah, vol. 4, p. 217

² Al-Mu‘jam al-Awsaṭ, vol. 5, p. 13, Hadith: 6429

³ Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim, p. 1014, Hadith: 6268; Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī, vol. 4, p. 91, Hadith: 5966 derived

⁴ Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim, p. 134, Hadith: 662

⁵ Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī, vol. 1, p. 253, Hadith: 707 derived

Some Unique Habits of Imam Aḥmad Razā Khān رَحْمَةُ اللهِ عَلَيْهِ

Asif Khan Attari Madani

Dear Islamic brothers! Reading about the character and habits of the saints and righteous elders certainly creates a passion for doing good deeds. Therefore, some noble habits of the Imam of Ahl al-Sunnah, Imam Aḥmad Razā Khān رَحْمَةُ اللهِ عَلَيْهِ are presented below:

1. Imam Aḥmad Razā Khān رَحْمَةُ اللهِ عَلَيْهِ would accept invitations from poor people. If the food there was not according to his taste, he would not mention it to the host. Instead, he would eat it happily.¹
2. He always helped the poor and never sent them away empty-handed. Even in his final moments, he advised his relatives and family to take special care of the poor. He told them to serve the poor delicious and high-quality food from his home and never to scold a poor person.²
3. He would forbid people from writing "بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ", Quranic verses, the name of "الله" the name of the holy Prophet "محمد" or *ṣalawāt* on postcards or open letters to prevent any disrespect. He would write the numerical value of "بِسْمِ اللَّهِ" starting from the right side.
4. In a gathering of Mawlid, he would sit respectfully on his knees from the beginning until the end. He would only stand up to recite *ṣalāt* and *salām*. Similarly, while delivering a speech, he would sit on his knees on the pulpit for four to five hours.³
5. His way of sleeping was also very unique. He did not sleep like common people. While sleeping, he would place his thumb over his index finger so that his fingers formed the word "Allah." He never stretched his legs out while sleeping. Instead, he would lie on his right side, join both hands and place them under his head, and tuck his legs in. In this way, his body would form the word "Muhammad."⁴

If only we, the devotees of Imam Aḥmad Razā Khān رَحْمَةُ اللهِ عَلَيْهِ, are also blessed with the ability to follow these beautiful habits of his.

¹ Hayat-e-Ala Hazrat, vol. 1, p. 123, *mulakhaṣan*

² Tazkirah-e-Imam Ahmad Raza, p. 14

³ Hayat-e-Ala Hazrat, vol. 1, p. 98

⁴ Hayat-e-Ala Hazrat, vol. 1, p. 99, *mafhūman*

THE BLESSED DOMESTIC LIFE OF THE HOLY PROPHET ﷺ

Sayyid Imran Akhtar Attari Madani



The life of the merciful Prophet ﷺ is an excellent example for everyone to follow. Despite the heavy responsibility of preaching the religion, the beloved Prophet ﷺ showed great kindness to his pure wives and his daughters. His noble treatment serves as a guide for the entire Ummah. The holy Prophet ﷺ said: “The best among you is the one who is best to his family, and I am the best among you to my family.”¹ Let us look at some aspects of his home life.

Seeking the Happiness of the Pure Wives

The holy Prophet ﷺ used to comfort and please his pure wives رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُنَّ. Once, the noble Prophet ﷺ miraculously fed grapes from Paradise to the Mother of the Believers, Sayyidah Khadījah al-Kubrā رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهَا, to make her happy.²

Cheerfulness and Good Humour

In accordance with the circumstances, the holy Prophet ﷺ was cheerful with his wives. Sayyidah ‘Ā’ishah al-Ṣiddīqah رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهَا narrates: “I was with the beloved Prophet ﷺ on a journey. We stopped at a place, and the holy Prophet ﷺ asked the Companions رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمْ to go ahead. Then he had a race with me. At that time, I was slim, so I won the race. After some time, during another journey, he again asked the Companions رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمْ to move forward and raced with me.

At that time, I had gained some weight, so the holy Prophet ﷺ won. He then gently patted my shoulder and said, “This is the return for that [victory].”³

(Note: This race took place in private, so this Hadith cannot be used to justify modern-day

mixed-gender racing).

Similarly, the holy Prophet ﷺ would express happiness at the mutual cheerfulness of his pure wives and sometimes even participate in it. Sayyidah ‘Ā’ishah رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهَا narrates:

I prepared a dish called *khazīrah* (made of meat and flour) for the holy Prophet ﷺ and presented it to him. The holy Prophet ﷺ was sitting between me and Sayyidah Sawdah رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهَا. I asked Sayyidah Sawdah رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهَا to eat, but she refused. I said, “Either you eat, or I will apply it to your face.” She still refused. So, I took some *Khazīrah* with my hand and applied it to her face. The holy Prophet ﷺ began to smile. He then picked up some *Khazīrah* and gave it to Sayyidah Sawdah رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهَا and said, “Now you apply it to her face too.” The holy Prophet ﷺ expressed his happiness at that time.⁴

Teaching Religious Knowledge

The beloved Prophet ﷺ also taught his pure wives religious knowledge. In this matter, the names of Sayyidah ‘Ā’ishah and Sayyidah Umm Salamah رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا are foremost. They received precious jewels of knowledge from the holy Prophet ﷺ. In fact, Sayyidah ‘Ā’ishah رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهَا held such a high status that she used to solve the most difficult intellectual problems with ease.⁵

Special Care for the Rights of the Pure Wives

Before his passing, during his final illness, the holy Prophet ﷺ

wanted to spend his time at the home of Sayyidah ‘Ā’ishah al-Ṣiddīqah رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهَا. Instead of simply announcing his decision, he showed great care for the rights of all his wives. He repeatedly asked, “Where will I be tomorrow?” The pure wives رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُنَّ understood his wish and said, “You may stay wherever you like.” Thus, he stayed at the home of Sayyidah ‘Ā’ishah al-Ṣiddīqah رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهَا until his passing.⁶

Consultation (Mashwarah)

The holy Prophet صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَآلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ would also consult with them. He would seek their opinions and encourage them. At times, he sought their advice in very sensitive situations. For example, he consulted Sayyidah Khadijah رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهَا when the first revelation (wahy) descended.⁷ Similarly, on the occasion of the Treaty of Hudaibiyah, he consulted Sayyidah Umm Salamah رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهَا and accepted her proposal.⁸

Excellent Treatment of Daughters

He also treated his daughters with great care and kindness. He would be happy at their joy and

saddened at their grief. He would even stand up out of love upon the arrival of his most beloved daughter, Sayyidah Faṭimah رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهَا.⁹

These noble character traits not only provide guidance for a happy home life for the Ummah but also clearly show the high status of women in Islam.

¹ Sunan al-Tirmidhī, vol. 5, p. 475, Hadith: 3921, derived

² Al-Mu‘jam al-Awsaṭ, vol. 4, p. 315, Hadith: 6098, summarised

³ Al-Sunan al-Kubrā li al-Nasā’ī, vol. 5, p. 304, Hadith: 8943

⁴ Musnad Abī Ya‘lā, vol. 4, p. 88, Hadith: 4459

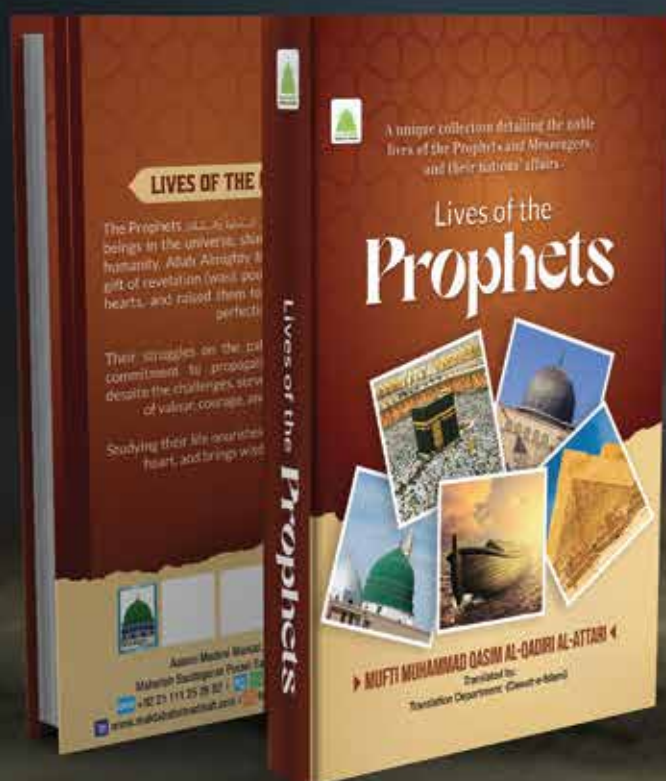
⁵ Sunan al-Tirmidhī, vol. 5, p. 471, Hadith: 3909, derived

⁶ Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhari, vol. 3, p. 468, Hadith: 5217

⁷ Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhari, vol. 1, p. 8, Hadith: 3, derived

⁸ Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhari, vol. 2, p. 227, Hadith: 2732, derived

⁹ Subul al-Hudā wa al-Rashād, vol. 11, p. 44, derived



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THE FIELD OF KARBALA

Asif Jahanzeb Attari Madani

On the 10th of *Muharram* 61 AH, a very painful event in the history of Islam took place. The noble family of the holy Prophet ﷺ (*Ahl al-Bayt*) and their loyal companions were martyred by the army of Yazid while they were hungry and thirsty. The place where this historical event happened is named Karbala. It is located near the Euphrates River, about 80 kilometres from Najaf and 103 kilometres from Baghdad. It is also about 75 kilometres away from Kufa. Previously, it was a desert, but now it is a city in the country of Iraq.

Linguistic and Historical Status of Karbala

The word Karbala is made of two words: "*Karb*" and "*Balā*".¹ Some experts of language say it comes from the word "*Karbal*" (sifted wheat) or "*Karbalah*" (marshy land) because the ground there is soft and free of pebbles. According to another opinion, "*Karbal*" is the name of a weed that used to grow there, which is why this place was named Karbala.² In the blessed *aḥādīth*, this place has also been mentioned by the names "*Nīnawā*" and "*Taff*".³

Importance of Karbala in Islam

This place holds special importance in Islamic history because the holy Prophet ﷺ, through the knowledge of the unseen granted by Allah Almighty, gave news about the martyrdom of Sayyidunā Imam Ḥusayn رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ. It is narrated by the Mother of the Believers, Sayyidah Umm Salamah رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهَا, that Angel Jibrīl عَلَيْهِ السَّلَام came to the holy Prophet ﷺ and informed him that after him, his Ummah would martyr his grandson (Sayyiduna Imam Ḥusayn رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ) at a place called Karbala. Then, he presented the soil of the place of martyrdom to the beloved Prophet ﷺ. The holy Prophet ﷺ smelled it and said: "رِيحُ كَرْبَلَاءَ", "The smell of distress and calamity [comes from it]."⁴

Then the holy Prophet ﷺ gave that soil to Sayyidah Umm Salamah رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهَا and said: "When this soil turns into blood, know that Ḥusayn has been martyred."⁵

Sayyidunā ‘Alī Passing Through the Field of Karbala

It is narrated that when the Leader of the Believers, Sayyidunā ‘Alī b. Abī Tālib كَرَّمَ اللَّهُ تَعَالَى وَجْهَهُ الْكَرِيم,

passed through Karbala, he رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ said: "This is where their rides will be stopped, this is where their belongings will be placed, and this is where their blood will be shed."⁶ When the enemies surrounded the noble Imam, he رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ asked: "What is the name of this place?" They replied: "Karbala." He then said: "Indeed, the holy Prophet ﷺ spoke the truth that this is the land of distress and calamity (*Karb wa Balā*)."⁷

Resting places of the Martyrs of Karbala

After the event of Karbala, the people of the tribe of *Ghāḍiriyyah* performed the burial of the martyrs of Karbala رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمْ.⁸

¹ Fayrūz al-Lughāt, p. 1060

² Mu‘jam al-Buldān, vol. 4, p. 125 derived

³ Muṣannaf Ibn Abī Shaybah, vol. 21, p. 146, hadith: 38522; Al-Mu‘jam al-Kabīr, vol. 3, p. 106, Hadith: 3813

⁴ Dalā’il al-Nubuwwah li-Abī Nu‘aym, p. 330, summarised; Tārīkh Ibn ‘Asākir, vol. 14, p. 193

⁵ Al-Mu‘jam al-Kabīr, vol. 3, p. 108, Hadith: 2817-2819, *mafhūman*

⁶ Al-Ṣawā’iq al-Muḥriqah, p. 193, summarised

⁷ Al-Mu‘jam al-Kabīr, vol. 3, p. 108, Hadith: 2812, summarised

⁸ Al-Kāmil fī al-Tārīkh, vol. 3, p. 433

The Preaching of Islam by Dātā Ganj Bakhsh

Bilal Saeed Attari Madani

The role of the Sufis was very important for the spread of Islam in the Indian subcontinent. Through their excellent character and preaching, the light of Islam spread throughout this region. People came out of the darkness of disbelief and misguidance and entered the light of Islam and guidance. Among those who spread the religion of Islam in this region, the name of Sayyidunā ‘Alī b. ‘Uthmān al-Hujwīrī, also known as Dātā Ganj Bakhsh رَحْمَةُ اللهِ عَلَيْهِ, is especially prominent.

A Short Introduction

His blessed birth took place approximately 1039 years ago, around 400 AH, in Ghazni (Eastern Afghanistan). His family lived in two neighbourhoods of Ghazni called Jullab and Hujwir. This is why he رَحْمَةُ اللهِ عَلَيْهِ is called Hujwīrī Jullābī.¹ His teknonym is Abū al-Ḥasan, his name is ‘Alī, his title is Dātā Ganj Bakhsh, and his spiritual chain is Junaydī (which later became famous as the Qādirī order).

The Reason for Being Called Ganj Bakhsh

It is narrated that Sayyidunā Khwājah Gharīb Nawāz رَحْمَةُ اللهِ عَلَيْهِ stayed at the luminous resting place of Dātā Ganj Bakhsh رَحْمَةُ اللهِ عَلَيْهِ for a long time to gain spiritual blessings. At the time of leaving, he said with great passion:

Ganj bakhsh faiz-e-alam mazhar-e-noor-e-Khuda

Naqisan ra peer-e-kamil, kamilan ra rahnuma

After this, people began to call him by the title of "Ganj Bakhsh". According to most historians, he رَحْمَةُ اللهِ عَلَيْهِ passed away on 20th Šafar al-Muẓaffar 465 AH. His magnificent resting place is in Lahore and is a place where prayers are accepted.²

Preaching Islam

Following the order of his spiritual guide, Sayyidunā Abū al-Faḍl b. Ḥasan al-Khuttalī رَحْمَةُ اللهِ عَلَيْهِ, he began the work of preaching Islam in Lahore. In those days, the journey from Ghazni to Lahore was very difficult. However, for the sake of

Allah's pleasure and spreading Islam, he accepted this hardship wholeheartedly. Crossing difficult mountains and rivers, he arrived in Lahore in 431 AH.³

To promote and spread the religion, he first laid the foundation of a masjid there. He then began teaching to spread the light of knowledge and wisdom. Day and night, he taught the noble Quran and Hadith and provided solutions to the daily problems of the people. Impressed by his good character, nobility, and sincerity, non-Muslims entered the fold of Islam in large numbers.⁴ Similarly, because of his supplications and advice, the deputy governor of Lahore, Rai Raju, also became a Muslim.⁵

He authored about nine books, including the masterpiece *Kashf al-Mahjūb*. This book serves as an unmatched guide for those seeking guidance and reform until the Day of Judgement.⁶ As a result of the preaching of Dātā 'Alī Hujwīrī رَحْمَةُ اللهِ عَلَيْهِ over many years, a city that was once drowned in the darkness of disbelief and polytheism became a fortress of Islam. Thousands of unlearned people gained

knowledge and became scholars. Those who were misguided found the right path. People without understanding gained the wealth of wisdom. Those who were spiritually incomplete became complete, while those who were already complete were further perfected. Scholars and spiritual guides came from far and wide to his court and had their spiritual aspirations fulfilled.⁷

The spiritual blessings of Dātā Ṣāhib continue even today in full glory and will continue until the Day of Judgement. إِنَّ شَاءَ اللهُ عَزَّوَجَلَّ

¹ Madina-tul-Awliya, p. 468

² Faizan-e-Data Ali Hujwiri, p. 74

³ Abduhu-Allah kay khas banday, p. 466, summarised

⁴ Sayyid Hujwir, p. 121

⁵ Ganj Bakhsh Faiz-e-Alam, p. 57, summarised

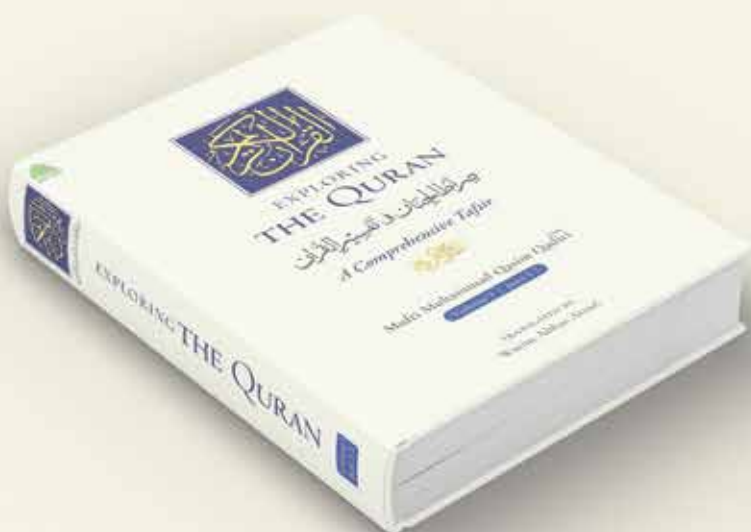
⁶ Extracted from Hayat-o-Afkar Hazrat Data Ganj Bakhsh, p. 97; Sayyid Hujwir, p. 231

⁷ Extracted from Abduhu-Allah kay khas banday, pp. 466-468; Ḥadiqat al-Awliya', p. 182

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Children! Stay Away From These Habits

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Distorting Names

Dear children! Changing someone's name or calling them by a name they dislike—such as "*Lambu*" (Tall), "*Kalu*" (Dark), or "*Motu*" (Fat)—is a sin. Allah Almighty has forbidden us from doing this. It is mentioned in the holy Quran: **وَلَا تَسَابُرُوا بِأَنَاءِقَابٍ**. Translation: "nor offend one another with nicknames."¹ Therefore, avoid distorting the names of others! If you see someone else doing it, stop them gently.

Mimicking Others

Some children watch how someone walks, talks, or moves their hands, and then copy them to make fun of them. This hurts the other person's feelings and causes them pain. Our beloved Prophet ﷺ said: "Whoever hurts a Muslim has indeed hurt me, and whoever hurts me has indeed displeased Allah."² Therefore, refrain from mimicking others.

Asking Others for Food

Some children have a bad habit of asking others for their food. This is not a good habit. It ruins their reputation, and because of this bad habit, other children do not like to sit or eat with them. Such children should bring food from their own homes and avoid asking others for it.

Reflect!

Do you have any of these bad habits?

¹ Al-Quran, Surah al-Hujurat, verse 11; translation from Kanz al-Irfan

² Al-Mu'jam-ul-Awsat, vol. 2, p. 386, Hadith: 3607



The Way to Lead a Peaceful Life

(Extracted from the Book "Learn the obligatory sciences")

Comfort and satisfaction are such treasures that every anxious person wants to attain. The creation has adopted many ways to access and unearth this treasure, but at one point in life or another, those ways prove to be perishable just like the creation. This treasure is not found either. However, its seeker is plunged into the swamp of despair.

Allah Almighty has granted the straight path to reach comfort and satisfaction i.e. the religion, Islam. In Islam, excellent laws and principles, and tremendous instructions are available for the people related to all walks of life regarding the religion, the world, the hereafter, ethics, outer and inner self, and domestic, family, social and economic matters, rather regarding all matters. Only Islam is the favoured religion of Allah Almighty.

Hence, Allah Almighty has truthfully declared in part 6, Surah Maa'idah, verse number 3:

الْيَوْمَ اكْمَلْتُ لَكُمْ دِينَكُمْ وَأَتِمَمْتُ عَلَيْكُمْ نِعْمَتِي وَرَضِيتُ لَكُمُ
الْإِسْلَامَ دِينًا

This day, I have perfected your religion for you, and completed My favour upon you, and chosen Islam for you as a religion.

Similarly, Allah Almighty said in part 3, Surah Aal-e-Imran, verse number 19:

إِنَّ الدِّينَ عِنْدَ اللَّهِ الْإِسْلَامُ

Indeed, the only 'acceptable' religion before Allah is Islam.

We learn from these verses that only the religion Islam is that single religion in which there is all the goodness of the world and the hereafter, and true peace of heart also lies in embracing this true religion.

A very basic cause of a person's anxiousness and dissatisfaction is ignorance. That is why the religion of Islam has made it necessary for every Muslim man and woman to attain knowledge, because there is nothing better than knowledge. Knowledge saves the heart from blindness and blesses it with the light of insight and guidance. Through it, a person reaches the stations of pious people and elevated ranks. Pondering over it is equivalent to fasting and

preaching it is equivalent to standing in worship at night. Through knowledge alone, Allah Almighty's worship and obedience are performed. Through it, all the ethical, social and other matters related with life are carried out. By virtue of knowledge alone, beautification occurs in the character of a human, realisation of one's responsibilities develops and inclination is attained to fulfil one's obligations. How did the Holy Prophet ﷺ make the people living in the society realise the importance of knowledge? Have a look at the following Hadith to get an idea of it: Your going to learn one chapter of knowledge in the morning is better than 100 Rak'at of Nafil Salah.¹

In another narration, he said the following: Faith is unclothed. Its clothes are piety, its beautification is modesty and its fruit is knowledge.²

He said in another Hadith: *إِنَّمَا الْعِلْمُ بِالتَّعَلُّمِ* i.e. knowledge is attained only by learning.³

After reading such narrations, a person feels like attaining knowledge but quite often, he cannot decide what is necessary to learn and what is not. Sometimes, what happens is that a person wishes to acquire the knowledge necessary for him but he remains unable to do so because of his engagements or other reasons.

The significance of attaining knowledge has become clear but it is also necessary to know which knowledge is necessary to acquire. So, Islam has told us that whoever wishes to lead a pleasant life, first of all, should acquire the following five sciences: 1) Beliefs and ideologies 2) worships 3) dealings 4) virtues (i.e. good traits) 5) vices (i.e. evil traits). Have a look at a brief introduction to and the importance of these sciences:

1. Islamic beliefs: Keep in mind that the word, 'Aqeedah' is derived from 'Aqd' which means to tie or knot, whereas in literal terms, a tied or knotted thing is called 'Aqeedah'.⁴

In the terminology of Shari'ah, 'Aqeedah' refers to those religious matters upon which the heart becomes firm without any doubt, suspicion or hesitation, because doubt, suspicion and hesitation in any matter of the religion is Kufr.⁵

2. Worships: After attaining the knowledge of

beliefs, secondly, attaining the knowledge of worships is necessary. Therefore, it is necessary to have knowledge about worship before performing it, for example, the Faraid and Wajibat of Wudu, Ghusl (the ritual bath) and Salah, if one intends to go for Hajj, then the rulings of Hajj, if Allah Almighty has granted wealth, then the rulings of paying Zakah, rulings of observing the fasts of the month of Ramadan, etc. are necessary and important to learn.

3. Dealings: If we also wish that we may remain at peace, our society may become a hub of peace, the examples of our honesty should be given and the Muslim Ummah should find convenience through our dealings, then for that, it is necessary to learn the Islamic principles and act upon them. Just like the religion Islam provides education and guidance on performing worships such as Salah, fasting, Hajj and Zakah, similarly, it also provides complete guidance regarding dealings. Keep in mind that the society we live in, it is necessary to gain each other's trust in it in order to make progress, because without mutual assistance, it is difficult to take even a single step forward in the world. To strengthen this assistance, it is also necessary to learn the bright teachings of Islam regarding dealings and the day-to-day necessities.

4-5. Virtues and vices: As the religion Islam has made it compulsory to acquire religious knowledge regarding the reformation of apparent actions, at the same time, it has also made it compulsory to acquire knowledge about the actions that pertain to the heart. The Holy Prophet ﷺ said while emphasising the reformation of the heart: There is a piece of flesh in a human's body, if it becomes correct, then all the actions of the person would become correct and if this piece is spoiled, then corruption occurs in all the actions. And that piece of flesh is the heart.⁶

¹ Ibn Majah, *Kitab al-Sunnah*, Bab Fadl Man Ta'allama al-Quran wa Allamahu, vol. 1, pp. 142-143

² Musnad al-Firdaus, Bab al-Alif, vol. 1 p. 72, Hadith 380

³ Bukhari, *Kitab al-Ilm*, Bab al-Ilm Qabl al-Qaul wa al-Amal, vol. p. 41

⁴ Lisan al-Arab, Bab al-Ayn, vol. 1, Hadith 2698

⁵ Al-Hadeeqah al-Nadiyyah, Khutbah al-Kitab, vol. 1, Hadith 30

⁶ Bukhari, *Kitab al-Iman*, Baab Fadl Mann Istabra'a li Deenih, vol. 1, p. 33, Hadith: 52, excerpted

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